20 Interview with KRSAN staff, 14 January 2015.
21 Interview with PYO members, 14 January 2015.
22 The Pa-O SAZ consists of three townships, Hopong, Hsihseng, and Pinlaung, and is formed under article 56(c) of the 2008 Constitution. The PNO won all the ten Pa-O SAZ seats, which included three lower house township seats, one upper house seat (Shan-9) and six Shan State assembly seats for these three townships.
23 The correct term should be 'village tract leader' but the quote is as per the term used.
24 Interview 7 January 2015.
25 On 24 March 2015, the team consisted of the author, an informant who also acted as translator, and a driver.
26 Interview, 7 November 2015.
27 The NLD leader of Taunggyi revealed that in early 2014 a member of the NLD was murdered in the middle of the night after he helped a villager with a land dispute case. The spouse of the deceased man claimed men in uniform dragged her husband to an open field in the middle of the night and shot him dead. According to a petition submitted to the Shan State Court, the perpetrators were PNA soldiers. Interview, 8 August 2014.
28 The chief executive claimed that the PNO would have easily obtained the permit because they would bribe the officials.
29 In May 2014, a leader of the SNLD from Namlinmau village was arrested by the Tatmadaw. He was accused of possessing firearms supplied by the RCSS/SSA-S. The SNLD issued a statement on 15 May 2014 denying the accusation and demanding the release of the party member. The statement did not deny the SNLD member was in possession of a gun supplied by RCSS/SSA-S, and interestingly it even went on to defend the RCSS/SSA-S by saying, "such kind of incident will not only affect [the] ceasefire agreement and peace process which [the] Union Peace-making Work Committee and RCSS/SSA-S [are] committing to implement but also will cause ethnic armed groups not to trust the government". Statement of SNLD, 15 May 2014 <http://www.burmapartnership.org/tag/shan-nationalities-league-for-democracy>. Accessed on 26 April 2015.
30 Interview with villagers, 7 November 2015.
31 When asked about what disadvantage they faced in their election campaign, the chief officer of the UPNO said the PNO were allowed to conduct their campaigns in local monasteries, which helped to convince the villagers that the PNO were good because they respect the monks. Interview, 6 November 2015.
32 Interview with the director of the PNLO, 6 November 2015.